percentage of total trade for both partners[45] and why Japan's focus has instead been on investments in India.

Looking forward

It is clear that since 2000 India has strengthened its alignment with Japan. This has taken the form of increased defence cooperation with Japan (and the United States), including joint training and exercises with the Japanese self-defence forces, diplomatic support for Japan's security policies vis-à-vis China, and a stronger India–Japan economic engagement. Taken together, these activities suggest a strategy of extensive hedging on the part of India vis-à-vis China, whereby Japan provides a long-term source of capabilities and policy coordination enabling New Delhi to adopt a mix of cooperative and confrontational policies toward Beijing.

According to the model in the introduction to this volume, the strongest indicator of the degree of alignment is the scope of military cooperation. From India's perspective, however, investing in a partnership with Japan is highly unlikely to have any effect on managing security risks in its relationship with China. This is partly why "balancing against China" is not a realistic short-term objective for India's Japan policy (and India does not pretend otherwise). In order for India to successfully insure against a Chinese security threat using Japan, at least one of three conditions would need to hold: 1) India and Japan are jointly able to compel China to accept their terms in any given crisis. 2) India and Japan are jointly able to deter China from engaging in actions hostile to their interests. 3) India and Japan are able to form a defensive alliance. A cursory assessment of the economic and military balance between